

Capstone Project Overview

1. Your Name:

Kantima Pinthong

2. The Name of your Project:

Inkspire

3. The Purpose of your Project: Who is it for and what does it do?

Inkspire is a web application designed for fiction writers who want to organize, plan, and develop their stories in one place. Writers can start by saving simple ideas in the Idea Vault and later develop an idea into a full story project. Within each story, they can manage characters, relationships, timelines, fictional worlds, chapters, scenes, research, and writing drafts.

The application is designed to help writers keep their story information organized, especially when working on long or non-linear stories. The main goal is to provide a single workspace where writers can move from an initial idea to a structured and written story.

A key feature of Inkspire is Story Check, which connects the information stored in different parts of the story. After a chapter is saved, the system can identify saved characters and locations mentioned in the chapter and display the Story Structure checklist created by the writer. This helps writers keep track of important story elements while keeping the creative decisions in the writer's control.

4. Your Intended Technology Stack

- Frontend: React, HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Backend: Node.js and Express
- Database: PostgreSQL
- API: REST API
- Authentication: User registration and login system
- Cloud Database: Online storage for user and story data
- Deployment: Cloud hosting for the web application and database

No third-party APIs are required for the core version of Inkspire.

5. User Roles

- Writer

A Writer is the main user of Inkspire. Writers can create and manage their story ideas and projects, develop characters and fictional worlds, plan their stories, write chapters and scenes, and track their writing progress.

- Admin

An Admin manages the application and user accounts. The Admin can view and manage users and perform basic system management tasks.

6. Your Features (this can be a bulleted list)

Must Have

- [Writer] Register and log in to an account
- [Writer] Create, edit, and delete story ideas in the Idea Vault
- [Writer] Develop an idea into a My Stories project
- [Writer] Create and manage story information
- [Writer] Create, edit, and delete characters using Character Studio
- [Writer] Create and organize Story Timeline events
- [Writer] Create Acts, Chapters, and Scenes using Story Builder
- [Writer] Create Story Structure checklists for chapters
- [Writer] Create and manage locations and basic world information using World Builder
- [Writer] Write and save chapters and scenes using the Writing Editor
- [Writer] Access saved writing from different devices through the online database
- [Writer] Use Story Check to view characters and locations mentioned in a chapter
- [Writer] View the Story Structure checklist for a chapter and manually mark planned elements as complete
- [Admin] Manage user accounts

Should Have

- [Writer] Create relationships between characters using Relationship Map
- [Writer] Automatically save writing drafts
- [Writer] Move planned Story Structure items to another chapter
- [Writer] Delete planned Story Structure items
- [Writer] Add notes and research to a story using Research Vault
- [Writer] Track word count and chapter completion
- [Writer] Set writing goals and deadlines
- [Writer] View previous saved drafts
- [Writer] View more detailed Story Check information
- [Admin] View basic application and user activity

Nice to Have

- [Writer] Export stories or chapters to PDF or DOCX
- [Writer] Manage multiple books as a series
- [Writer] More advanced writing analytics
- [Writer] Improved draft version history and recovery
- [Writer] Additional customization options for story organization
- [Admin] Additional system management and reporting features

7. Narrative Descriptions for each User Role

- **Writer**

Emma [Writer] is a fiction writer who wants to organize her ideas and develop a new novel. She registers for an account with Inkspire and logs in to her workspace. She starts by adding several ideas to her Idea Vault. When she decides to develop one of her ideas, she moves it into My Stories and creates a new story project with a title, genre, synopsis, and basic plot. Emma then develops her story by creating characters in Character Studio and adding information such as their personality, background, and goals. She uses the Story Timeline to organize important events in chronological order. Since her story takes place in a fictional world, she also uses World Builder to create locations and other world information.

Before she starts writing, Emma uses Story Builder to organize her novel into Acts, Chapters, and Scenes. For each chapter, she creates a Story Structure checklist containing the important events she wants to include. She then opens the Writing Editor and begins writing her chapter. Her work is saved to the online database so she can continue writing later from another device. After saving the chapter, Emma uses Story Check. Inkspire checks the chapter for characters and locations that she has already created in the story and displays them for her to review. It also shows the Story Structure checklist she created for that chapter. Emma can manually mark items as complete, delete items she no longer wants to use, or move an item to another chapter. She can then continue writing while using Inkspire to keep her story information organized.

This user journey requires user authentication, CRUD functionality for ideas, stories, characters, locations, timeline events, chapters, scenes, and story structure items. It also requires a relational database to connect these records to the correct user and story, a REST API to communicate between the frontend and backend, and text matching functionality for the Story Check feature.

- **Admin**

An Admin logs into the administrative area of Inkspire to manage the application. The Admin can view registered users and manage user accounts when necessary. The Admin is responsible for basic system management rather than creating or editing users' story content.

The Admin role provides a separate level of access from the Writer role and helps maintain the application's user management and overall operation.